

SHOWCASE

LUGER LANGE P.08 PISTOL

Recognized worldwide, this distinctive gun was used heavily by German forces in both world wars because of its reliability, accuracy, and light weight. It is one of the earliest self-loading pistols (see p.166), but unlike others, it is equipped with a recoil-operated toggle-lock instead of the slide action that later became standard. Firing the gun pushes the breechblock backward, folding the toggle and ejecting the spent cartridge.

► **LOADING INDICATOR WITH CARTRIDGE**

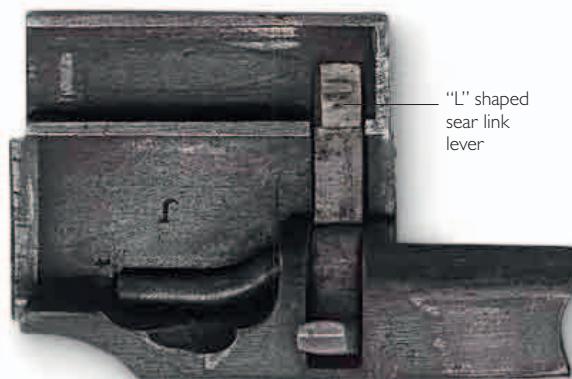
The extractor, or loading indicator, is attached to the breechblock. When a cartridge is in place, the extractor lifts upward at the front, exposing the word “geladen” (loaded) stamped on its side. It is easy to see, and feel, if a Luger pistol is loaded. Most Luger pistols used the Parabellum cartridge, which became the standard pistol round of armies across the world.



Barrel

▲ **BARREL AND LOCK ASSEMBLY**

The barrel fits into a block that has two plates projecting rearward. The toggle assembly is fitted between these plates. The barrel and the toggle assemblies are attached to the main frame (receiver) of the pistol. To field-strip the gun for cleaning, the barrel assembly is pushed backward. This allows the user to turn the release lever clockwise and lift off the sideplate. The user can then pull out the release lever, allowing the barrel assembly to slide forward out of the receiver.



▲ **SIDEPLATE**

Unique to the Luger is an L-shaped lever located on the inner side of the sideplate. This lever connects the trigger with the sear. The sear in this gun holds back a striker until the trigger is pulled. Without the sideplate in place, the gun is inoperable.

► **MAIN FRAME**

The main frame (receiver) of the gun houses the magazine, mainspring (inside the butt), and trigger, and provides the platform onto which the barrel and lock assembly fit.

Loading indicator

Breechblock contains a striker

Sideplate fits here

Toggle assembly fits here

Sear

Rear sight adjustment catch

Barrel assembly-retaining lug

Flat plate projects rearward

Slot in trigger mechanism for sear link lever

“L” shaped sear link lever

Sideplate release lever

